

# NATIONAL LEVEL TECHNICAL SYMPOSIUM – WHAT AN IDEA



## MEENAKSHI SUNDARARAJAN ENGINEERING COLLEGE

MANAGED BY IET SOCIETY  
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## EPSILON 2K26

NATIONAL LEVEL TECHNICAL SYMPOSIUM  
ELECTRICAL AND ELECTRONIC ENGINEERING

# WHAT AN IDEA

*Innovate. Present. Succeed.*



### About the Event

A startup pitch contest where participants present **innovative products**, services or business solutions before a panel of **industry** experts and investors. Showcase ideas, receive expert feedback, and compete to prove your idea's **market potential**.

**Event Details**  
 **16 March 2026**

9:30 AM – 4:00 PM | PSS Lab - Main Block,  
 PSS Lab - Main Block, MSEC

#### Round 1 – Elevator Pitch



- 3-minute pitch (No PPT)
- Judges evaluate:
  - Problem clarity
  - Innovation
  - Market potential
  - Communication
- 10 teams selected

#### Round 2 – Market Challenge



- 5-minute PPT/Product presentation
- 5-minute Q&A with judges
- Surprise market constraints introduced
- Top 5 teams advance

#### Final Round – Live Negotiation



- Teams negotiate investment with judges
- Participants must:
  - Ask investment amount
  - Offer equity
  - Justify valuation
  - Negotiate deal



Smart India 1Make  
Smart India / Make in India



AI & Automation  
Campus Startups

Register here:



**Pitch your idea. Build the future.**  
Registration Open Soon

# STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE

**Event Name:** *What an Idea!*

## 1. PURPOSE

To provide a competitive platform for students to pitch innovative product, business, or service ideas before an expert panel and gain feedback, exposure, and recognition.

## 2. EVENT STRUCTURE

Total Rounds: 3

- Round 1 – Preliminary Screening
  - Round 2 – Market Validation Round
  - Final Round – Investment & Negotiation Round
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## 3. ELIGIBILITY

- Open to undergraduate and postgraduate students.
- Team size: 1–4 members.
- Cross-department teams allowed.
- Only original ideas permitted.

## 4. REGISTRATION PROCESS

- Online registration form submission.
- Submission of:
  - Team details
  - Abstract (300–500 words)
  - Problem statement

- Proposed solution

Deadline: (Insert date)

## 5. ROUND DETAILS

### ◆ ROUND 1 – Elevator Pitch Round

**Mode:** Offline/Online screening

**Duration per team:** 3 minutes

**No PPT allowed**

Evaluation Criteria:

- Clarity of problem
- Innovation
- Relevance
- Communication

Top 10 teams qualify.

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### ◆ ROUND 2 – Market Viability Round

**Duration per team:**

- 5 min Presentation
- 5 min Q&A

Requirements:

- PPT (max 8 slides)
- Basic financial estimation required

Judges evaluate based on:

- Feasibility
- Market demand
- Revenue model
- Scalability
- Defense during Q&A



Top 5 teams qualify.

◆ **FINAL ROUND – Investment Negotiation Round**  
**Structure:**

- 5 min pitch refinement
- Live negotiation with judges/special guest
- Teams must:
  - Ask investment amount
  - Offer equity percentage
  - Justify valuation

Judges may:

- Counter offer
- Reject
- Offer conditional investment

Final decision based on:

- Innovation
- Market readiness
- Negotiation skill
- Investment worthiness

## **6. RULES & REGULATIONS**

1. Ideas must be original.
2. Plagiarism leads to disqualification.
3. Time limits are strict.
4. Teams must bring presentation in PPT/PDF format in pen drive.
5. No offensive, illegal, or unethical ideas permitted.
6. Judges' decision is final.
7. Any team indulging in misconduct will be disqualified.
8. Organizing committee reserves rights to modify rules if required.

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## **7. JUDGING PANEL**

Panel may include:

- Industry professional
- Startup founder
- Faculty expert
- Financial expert

## **8. PRIZES**

- Winner – Prize money
- Runner-up – Certificate
- Special Awards:
  - Most Innovative Idea
  - Best Presenter
  - Social Impact Award

## **9. LOGISTICS CHECKLIST**

Technical

- Projector
- HDMI cable
- Clicker
- Timer display
- Backup laptop
- Sound system

Documents

- Score sheets
- Attendance sheet

- Feedback forms
- Certificates

#### Team

- 1 Stage manager
- 1 Timekeeper
- 1 Tech support
- 1 Judge coordinator
- 1 Hospitality volunteer

#### **10. PARTICIPANT CONDUCT AND DISCIPLINE:**

- All participants must maintain professional and respectful behavior toward judges, faculty members, coordinators, and fellow participants.
- Communication must remain polite, clear, and technically appropriate at all times.
- Participants must strictly adhere to the allotted time for presentation and Q&A.
- Any clarification must be requested through event coordinators.
- Use of mobile phones during presentations is strictly prohibited.
- Disruptive behavior, plagiarism, or misconduct will lead to disqualification.
- Judges' decisions are final and binding

#### **11. DRESS CODE:**

- Participants must wear formal dress.
- Clothing must be neat, clean, and suitable for an academic presentation environment.
- ID cards must be worn visibly during the event.

#### **12. PRESENTATION ETHICS:**

- All content presented must be original work or properly cited.
- Plagiarism above the acceptable limit will result in disqualification.

- All references, diagrams, graphs, and research sources must be acknowledged.
- Use of offensive, misleading, or irrelevant content is strictly prohibited.

### **13. REGISTRATION AND ABSTRACT SUBMISSION:**

- All the participants are requested to register only in online, and everyone should be on time in a respected venue.
- Everyone should submit their abstract before the concern of people online.
- And the submission should be before the deadline.

### **14. EVENT DISCIPLINE:**

- Participants must report to the venue at least 15 minutes before their scheduled slot.
- Presentation order will be strictly followed.
- Failure to appear during the allotted time, they will participate at last.
- Audience members must maintain silence during presentations.
- Participants must not use any kind of vulgar words and any kind of religious words or unwanted words.